

on research is not well understood. While some have examined how AI can facilitate new research techniques, procedures, management, and assessment, there is insufficient empirical research on how the academic community is responding to these possibilities.

This section focuses on examining the intersection of AI and society by analyzing the role of AI in research policy and practice. Let us delve into the potential impact of AI on the research process and its various implications, both positive and negative. Specifically, let's explore the potential role of AI in research and investigate the extent to which AI's effects on the research workplace are beneficial or detrimental, and for whom.

Research is a highly competitive and rapidly evolving global field that faces increasing pressure to produce more results. In line with this trend, the UK government has set targets to invest a significant portion of its GDP in research and development. Notably, there has been a recent surge in AI research, with 77% of identified papers on AI published in the last 5 years alone. While AI can improve researcher efficiency and productivity, it can also create a performance-focused culture that prioritizes bureaucratic aims over individual and collective scholarly norms. Furthermore, the use of AI risks sacrificing traditional institutional roles and academic identities. Given the anticipated role of AI in Industry 4.0, it is crucial for higher education institutions to seriously consider the responsible innovation and ethical implications of AI in research practices, cultures, and governance.

